VAULTAIRE · USER JOURNEYS

How Vaultaire works

Everything you do in Vaultaire, as flowcharts: setting up, opening the vault, finding and showing secrets, adding things, locking, backups, and what to do when something goes wrong.

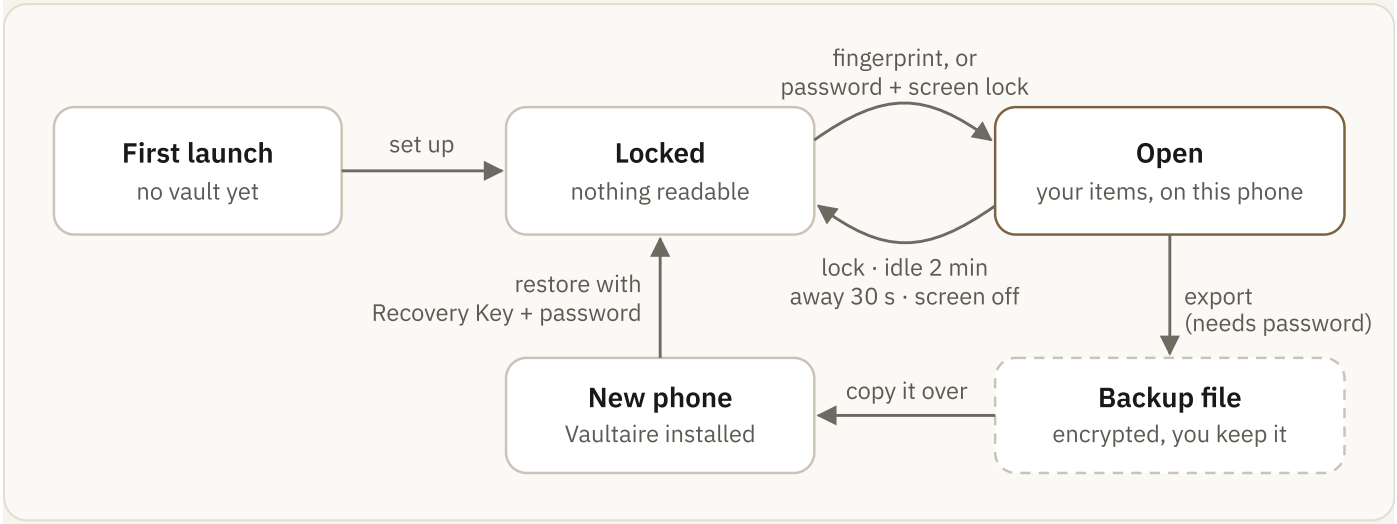
- Describes the app as designed (V1). The phone prototype shows most of these screens with sample data.

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The big picture

Your vault is always in one of two states: locked or open. Everything else is a way between them.



The only thing that ever leaves the phone is the backup file, and only when you export it. Restoring it onto a new phone needs your Recovery Key and vault password together, and gives you a vault there that opens like any other.

Your fingerprint

Opens the vault every day. Nothing to type.

Your vault password

The backup way in, and needed for anything that weakens your protection.

Your Recovery Key

28 characters you write down once, on paper. With your password, it gets you back in if the phone's keys are lost.

01 · ONCE

First-time setup

Seven short steps. You can't skip the Recovery Kit, because it is your only way back in if this phone ever loses its keys.

Open Vaultaire for the first time
Welcome screen

↓

How your vault works
Plain-language summary: it lives only on this phone, nobody (including us) can open it or reset it for you.

↓

◇ **Is this phone safe enough?**
Checks for a screen lock and hardware-protected key storage.

↓

YES

Continue
Also shows advisory warnings, such as an old security patch.

NO

Setup stops here
"Set a screen lock first." Vaultaire won't create a vault on a phone without one.

↺ try again after setting a screen lock

↓

Choose your vault password
Offered first: a generated 6-word passphrase. Or type your own: at least 12 characters and hard to guess.

↺ too weak? pick another

↓

◇ **Turn on fingerprint unlock?**
Warning shown first: anyone whose fingerprint is enrolled on this phone can open your vault.

↓

TURN ON

Touch the sensor
Daily unlock is now one touch.

SKIP

Password-only mode
For people who share a phone or want the strictest setup. Can be changed later.

↓

Your Recovery Key
28 characters in 7 groups. Write it by hand. Screenshots, PDFs and printing are blocked.

◇ **Type groups 3 and 6 from your paper**

Proves you actually wrote it down. Letter case, spaces and dashes don't matter.

`↺ doesn't match? check your handwriting, or show the key again`

matches

Your vault is ready

It opens, empty, with "Add your first item".

02 · EVERY DAY

Opening your vault

Fingerprint first. The vault password is the backup, and it always needs your phone's screen lock too, so someone who only knows your phone PIN can't get in.

Open Vaultaire
Lock screen with the logo and the unlock ring. The fingerprint prompt appears by itself.

FINGERPRINT

◇ **Does it match?**
Checked by the phone's secure hardware, which then releases the key.

YES

Ring closes, vault opens

NO OR CANCELLED

Stay on the lock screen
Try again, or use your vault password. After too many tries the phone pauses fingerprint for a while.

VAULT PASSWORD

Type your vault password

Phone asks for its screen lock
PIN, pattern or password. Both are needed.

◇ **"Verifying..."**
The dial turns while the password is checked (about a second).

CORRECT

Vault opens

WRONG

"Incorrect password."
From the 5th wrong try you must wait: 30 s, 1 min, 5 min, 15 min, 1 h, then 3 h each. Restarting the phone doesn't shorten it.

after it opens

◇ **Were there failed attempts while you were away?**
If yes, a banner says so: "3 failed password attempts since your last unlock".

◇ **Is your password check due?**

Every 14 days, after a fingerprint unlock, you're asked to type your vault password so you don't forget it. You can put it off once, for 24 hours.

`↺ forgot it? reset it with your Recovery Key (see 08)`

Your vault home screen

Changed your fingerprints? If you add or remove a fingerprint in your phone's settings, fingerprint unlock turns itself off. Type your vault password once and it turns back on. This stops someone from adding their own finger to get in.

03

Finding things

The home screen is one page of sections. Cards always come first; you choose the order of the rest.

Home screen
Greeting, a "Protections on" line, search, then your sections: Cards, Passwords, API keys, Bank accounts, Identity, Notes, Memberships.

BROWSE

Tap a section heading
Opens that category: every item in it, and one line on how it's protected.

Tap an item
Opens its details. Cards show the card face and finish.

SEARCH

Type in search
Searches titles and names across every category, hidden ones included. Results stay grouped by category.

Tap a result
Opens its details.

ORGANISE

"Organise sections"
At the bottom of home, or Settings → Appearance.

Move sections up or down, or hide them
Cards stay pinned first. Changes apply at once; "Reset to default" undoes them.

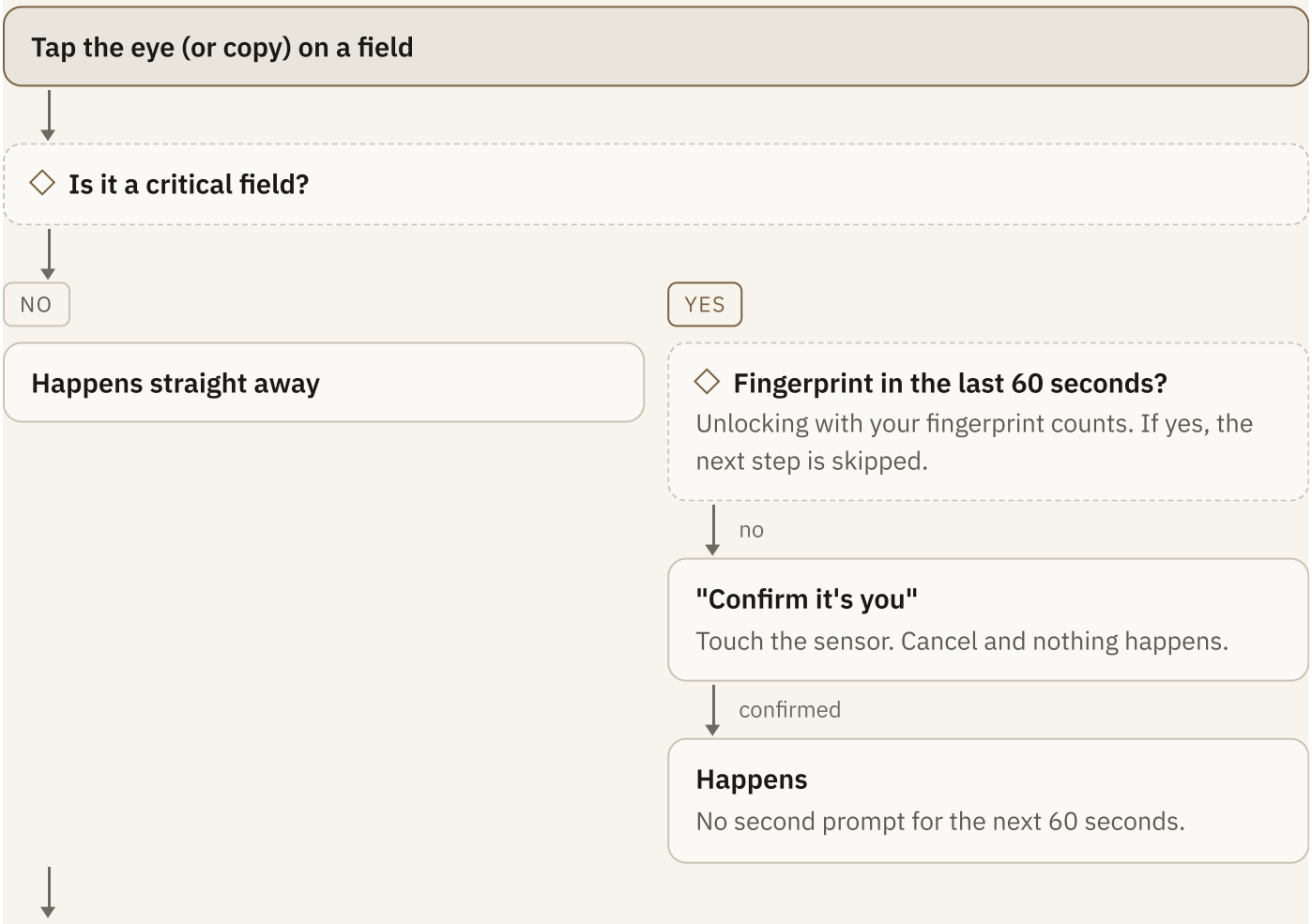
Hiding is tidying, not protection. A hidden section's items are still in your vault, still found by search, still in your backups, and listed at the bottom of home ("Hidden from home: API keys (2)").

04

Showing and copying secrets

Every field has one of three protection levels. The level decides what you need to do to see or copy it.

LEVEL	EXAMPLES	TO SEE IT	TO COPY IT
NORMAL	Titles, usernames, bank name, expiry date, websites	Always shown	Tap copy
CONCEALED	Passwords, membership PINs, note text, Wi-Fi password	Tap the eye	Tap copy
CRITICAL	Card number, CVV (if you stored it), account numbers, document numbers, API secrets, recovery codes	Tap the eye, then fingerprint	Tap copy, then fingerprint



SHOWN

One field at a time

Hides again after 30 seconds, when you leave the screen, when you switch apps, or when the vault locks.

COPIED

"Copied · clears in 60 s"

The clipboard is marked sensitive and cleared after 60 seconds, and at once if you lock.

05

Adding something

Each type has its own form, with the sensitive fields already set to the right protection level.

Tap +
Or "Add password" (and so on) on a category page, which skips the next step.

↓

Choose a type
Card, Password, API key, Bank account, Identity, Secure note, Membership, Other.

↓

PASSWORD

A strong passphrase is suggested
6 random words. "Generate" gives a new one, or type your own.

CARD

◇ **Also store the security code?**
Switch is off by default.

↓ switched on

Warning, then the CVV field
Number, expiry and CVV together are all anyone needs to shop online with the card. Stored as critical, never autofilled.

↓

Card PIN: never
There is no field for it.

OTHERS

Fill in the form
Critical fields are marked, such as account numbers and API secrets.

↓

Save
You land on that category, with the new item in it.

06

Locking

Locking happens often and on its own. It is instant: the screen is cleared before any animation plays.

YOU

Tap the lock icon
Always in the top corner.

IDLE

2 minutes untouched
Adjustable, but never "never".

AWAY

30 seconds in the background
Or the screen turns off, or the app is closed.

↓

Everything is cleared
Keys wiped from memory, revealed fields hidden, clipboard cleared.

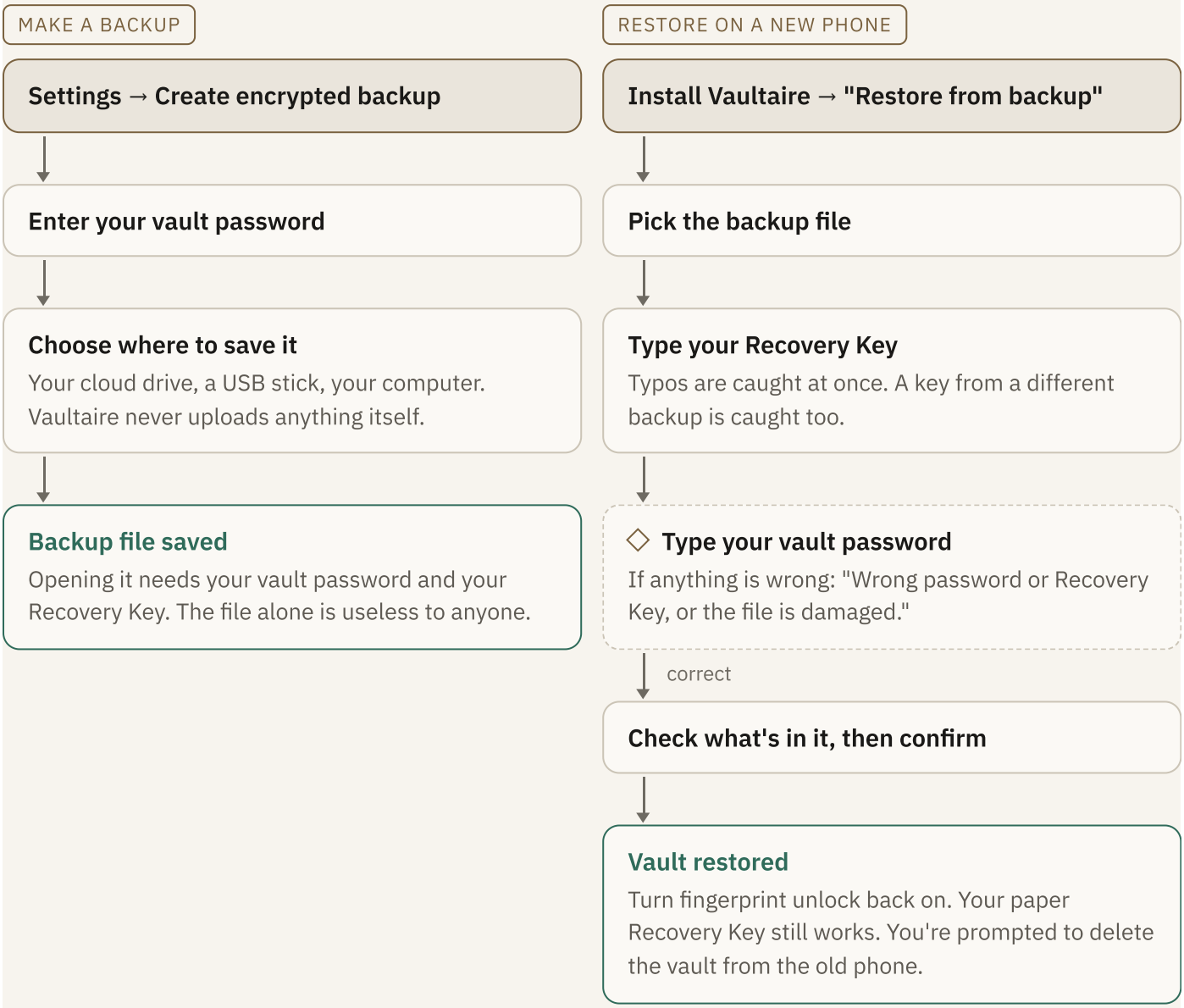
↓

Lock screen
Back to journey 02 to open it again.

07

Backups and a new phone

Your vault exists only on this phone. A backup file is how it survives a lost or broken phone. You're reminded every 30 days.



Anything added after your last backup is not in it. Merging a backup into an existing vault is also possible: imported items are added as new and tagged "Imported" with the date. Nothing gets overwritten.

08

When something goes wrong

Pick what happened. Every way back needs two things, so no single lost or stolen secret opens your vault.

– I forgot my vault password — fingerprint still works

Open the vault with your fingerprint

↓

Settings → Reset vault password

↓

Type your Recovery Key

↓

Choose a new password
Make a new backup: older backups still need the old password.

– My fingerprint stopped working — after adding or removing one

"Your biometric settings changed"

↓

Enter your vault password (plus screen lock)

↓

Fingerprint unlock is back on

– I removed my phone's screen lock

The phone erased Vaultaire's unlock keys
Android does this on purpose. Fingerprint and password unlock both stop working.

↓

Set a screen lock again

↓

Enter your Recovery Key and vault password

↓

Vault opens; set up fingerprint again

– I lost my phone, or it broke

New phone → Restore from backup
Journey 07. Needs the backup file, your Recovery Key and your vault password.

↓

No backup?
The vault is gone. It was only ever on that phone. This is why backups are reminded every 30 days.

– I lost my Recovery Key — still know my password

Settings → Regenerate Recovery Key
Needs your vault password.

↓

Write down and confirm the new key

↓

Make a new backup
Old backups need the old key, which you no longer have.

– "This vault's data could not be verified"

The file was damaged or tampered with

Nothing is shown and nothing is changed. There is no "repair", on purpose.

Try again, or restore from your latest backup

– I forgot my password and my fingerprint doesn't work

The vault cannot be opened

Not by you, not by us, not by anyone. We never hold a copy of your keys, and there is no support-desk reset.

If you have a backup

You still need the password to open it. The periodic password check exists to stop this from happening.

We will never ask for your Recovery Key. You only ever type it into Vaultaire, in restore and reset screens. Anyone else asking for it is trying to steal your vault.

09

Changing settings

Making protection stronger is free. Making it weaker always needs your vault password.

STRONGER: NO PASSWORD

Examples

Shorter auto-lock, more frequent password checks, turning on password-only mode, hiding or reordering sections.

WEAKER: PASSWORD FIRST

Examples

Longer auto-lock, turning off fingerprint for critical fields, changing your password, exporting a backup, regenerating the Recovery Key.

Settings → Delete vault

↓

◇ **Export a backup first?**

Offered before anything happens.

↓

Enter your vault password

↓

Type DELETE

↓

Vault erased from this phone

Keys first, then data. Back to the welcome screen. Backup files you made elsewhere are out of our reach; delete them yourself.

Device protection check (Settings) shows what could weaken your phone's safety: no screen lock, an old security patch, USB debugging left on, a third-party keyboard, or no recent backup.

What Vaultaire never does

- Connect to the internet. The app has no network permission at all.
- Sync, upload, or keep an account for you.
- Let your phone PIN alone open the vault.
- Reset your vault through support, email or security questions.
- Ask for your Recovery Key.
- Store a card PIN.
- Store a CVV unless you switch it on for that card.
- Allow screenshots or screen recording of the app.
- Show vault items in notifications, widgets or phone search.
- Include analytics, ads or crash-reporting services.

Unaudited beta. Until an independent security review is published, don't store real credentials in Vaultaire.